

In summary, if you are starting to make money and have budgeted money for retirement, you should absolutely be participating in either an employer-sponsored 401(k) or an individual retirement account. Even if you can only afford a small amount, like \$25, from each paycheck, you should do it. Saving for retirement is a long and disciplined process. The earlier you can start, the less of a burden it will be; saving \$100 per paycheck now will probably be easier than waiting and being forced to try and save \$500 per paycheck later.